MariaDB to launch innovation research labs

MariaDB is launching a research division, called MariaDB Labs. With this, the open source database company will tackle the most pressing issues in the database field. To begin with, it has collaborated with Intel on a new reference architecture. Michael Howard, CEO, MariaDB, shared plans at the recently held M18 user conference in New York. He said that the labs will focus on three key areas—machine learning, distributed computing, and the use and exploitation of new chips, persistent storage and in-memory processing.

"Our research collaboration with MariaDB will focus on an innovative distributed log architecture using Intel Optane SSDs and Intel Persistent Memory woven together through high-performance fabrics," said Alper Ilkbahar, Intel VP, data centre group; and GM, data centre memory and storage solutions.

The collaboration will look into a new reference architecture for distributed databases using high-performance fabrics. "Our shared goal is to enable faster recovery and cloning, increase overall performance and resilience, and reduce solution TCO from today's level," elaborated Ilkbahar.

In terms of machine learning, MariaDB Labs will be tasked with investigating how to use supervised and unsupervised techniques to drive better automation, including self-configuration and self-optimisation when running databases in the cloud. The research will look at distributed computing, specifically improving upon Web-scale, geo-distributed deployments. Last but not the least, MariaDB Labs will look to develop next-generation chips, memory and storage in a bid to rethink the underlying infrastructure on which databases run.

for an automation-centric approach to IT management. The integrations are aimed at enabling users to not only identify critical risks, but also create enterprise change plans and automatically generate Ansible playbooks to remediate those risks.

By deepening the integration of Ansible technology across its management portfolio, Red Hat aims to better enable organisations to take a more agile and consistent approach to managing Red Hat environments and hybrid infrastructure.

With automation as a foundational capability, Red Hat Satellite 6.3 and Red Hat CloudForms 4.6 can help organisations to speed IT deployments and updates via improved provisioning while maintaining enhanced stability and performance. Red Hat Satellite 6.3 also provides greater flexibility for hybrid cloud computing with the addition of support for Satellite and Satellite Capsule Server running on Amazon EC2. Its customers are now able to manage their Red Hat infrastructure on Amazon EC2 with the backing of Red Hat's global customer support.

Source code for X-Pack released

The source code for commercial software that Elastic developed to extend the stack, will soon be opened. CEO Shay Banon announced that Elastic customers who had been paying for high-end enterprise features like machine learning (ML) in the X-Pack extension will no longer be relegated to a 'second-class citizen' experience.

Banon shared some interesting facts related to the release during his keynote address at the company's ElasticON conference in San Francisco. "This is a big chance for us. I'm super excited about it. I can't begin to explain how simple this will make things for us," he shared.

Elastic customers were upset about the quality of customer support they had been receiving. The complaints were the result of the different processes Elastic's customer support organisation used to help X-pack users resolve issues, versus how it interacted with customers who use its core open source Elastic stack, which includes Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana, and other tools.

"We're taking all of our commercial IP … and we're clicking 'make public' on GitHub," Banon said. "We're going to take that and hopefully get to a level where we collaborate with you regardless of whether you end up being an open source user or a customer, across all of our products, across the whole of the stack," he added.

Elastic offers two X-Pack packages. The basic version was made free two years ago and includes monitoring, while the other, which included advanced features like machine learning and graph analytics capabilities, required payment. "The problem was that even customers who used the free basic version of X-Pack were getting an inferior customer support experience compared to those who downloaded and used the open source products," Banon shared.

"If the code is closed, you can't open an issue; there's a different issue-tracking system," Banon explained. "The free features that we give you, which we truly believe every user of our stack should use, are not being used at the level we would like them to be, and in my mind this happens because of a lack of collaboration. We don't have the level of collaboration that we believe we should have with you, even on code that's not open source," he said.

Adoption of open source Selenium for automated testing at enterprise scale

To drive faster adoption of open source, LogiGear attended SauceCon 2018 as a specialised service partner of Sauce Labs. Further, the LogiGear - Sauce Labs partnership will help drive the adoption of Sauce Labs and open source Selenium.